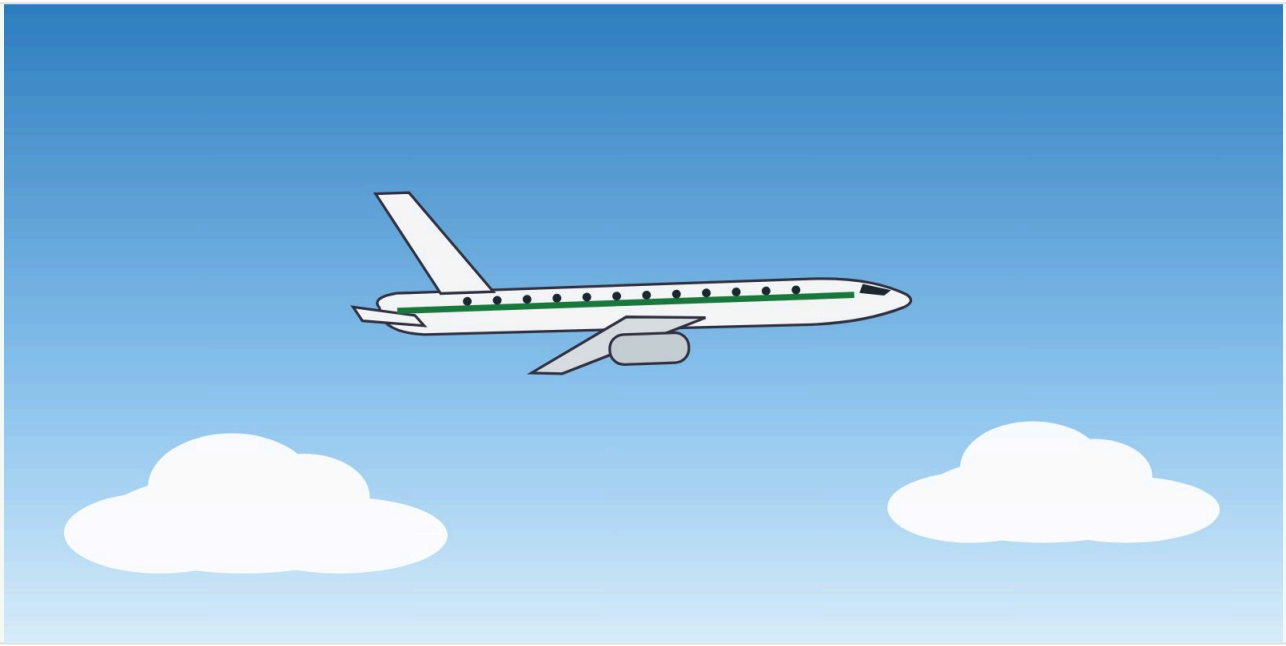
MODULE 1 · REGULATIONS

Lesson 01: The International Framework: ICAO

Lesson 1 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Describe the role of ICAO and the Chicago Convention.
- Distinguish Standards, Recommended Practices and guidance material.
- Identify the ICAO Annexes most relevant to flight crews.



ICAO SARPs are the foundation of every national rule.

ICAO and the Chicago Convention

The **Convention on International Civil Aviation** (Chicago, 1944) created the International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO). Contracting States agree to apply ICAO **Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs)**, published in the Annexes, and to notify ICAO of any **differences** (published in the AIP).

- **Standards** — “shall”: necessary for safety or regularity; States must comply or notify a difference.
- **Recommended Practices** — “should”: desirable; States endeavour to comply.
- **PANS** (e.g. PANS-OPS Doc 8168, PANS-ATM Doc 4444) — procedures with a wider level of detail.
- **Manuals and circulars** — guidance material (e.g. Doc 9613 PBN, Doc 9574 RVSM, Doc 10011 UPRT).

Annexes most relevant to flight crew

Annex	Subject
1	Personnel licensing

2	Rules of the air
3	Meteorological service
6	Operation of aircraft (Part I: international commercial air transport — aeroplanes)
8	Airworthiness
10 / 11	Aeronautical telecommunications / Air traffic services
12, 13	Search and rescue, Accident and incident investigation
14	Aerodromes
15	Aeronautical information services
17, 18, 19	Security, Dangerous goods, Safety management

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Chicago Convention created ICAO; States apply SARPs or notify differences.
- Standards (“shall”), Recommended Practices (“should”), PANS and guidance manuals.
- Annex 6 Part I is the core operational Annex for commercial air transport.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

What must a State do if it cannot comply with an ICAO Standard?

A. Nothing

B. Notify ICAO of the difference (published in the AIP)

C. Leave ICAO

D. Ask the operator to decide

Answer: B. Differences from Standards must be notified to ICAO.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.